BUSINESS ANALYSIS CASE STUDY

HR Onboarding Process Improvement

Reducing Onboarding Time by 40% through Process Redesign

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Executive Summary

TechServe India Pvt. Ltd. (850+ employees) faced a critical HR challenge: new hires took **8-11 days on average to become fully operational** due to 4 redundant approval steps, manual document processing, and siloed communication. The company lost an estimated Rs. 45,000/year in productivity costs, and 23% of early attrition cases cited poor onboarding as a factor.

As Business Analyst, I mapped the As-Is process using BPMN, performed gap analysis, documented 14 functional requirements, and delivered a To-Be process design with Agile user stories targeting a **40% reduction in onboarding time**.

8-11d	3.5d	4	23%	40%
Avg Onboarding (Before)	Target Onboarding (After)	Redundant Approval Steps	Early Attrition Linked to Onboarding	Projected Time Reduction

Business Problem Statement

Problem Dimension	Current State	Business Impact
Process Efficiency	Avg onboarding: 8-11 days	Rs. 45,000/yr in lost productivity
Approval Bottlenecks	4 sequential approvals, 2 redundant	3-day delay per new hire
Documentation	100% manual — paper forms, email	Errors, lost docs, re-work
Communication	No centralized tracking; siloed emails	New hire unaware of status
Employee Experience	New hire satisfaction: 5.8/10	23% early attrition linked to onboarding

Stakeholder Analysis

9 stakeholders identified across 4 organizational levels. RACI mapping used to define roles and responsibilities throughout the project.

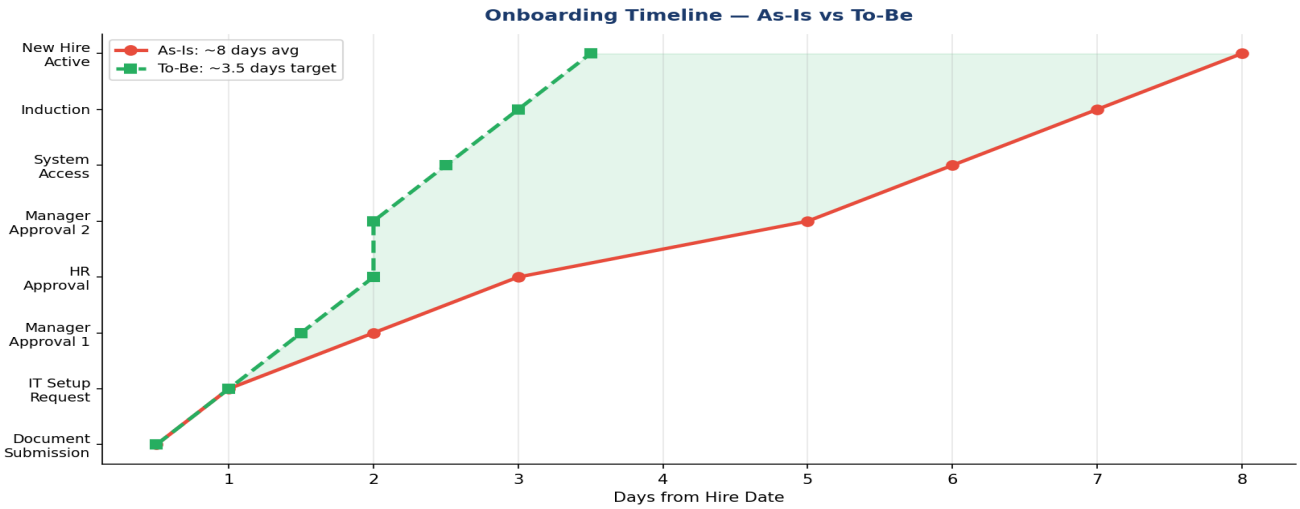
Stakeholder	Department	RACI	Influence	Key Concern	Engagement
CHRO / HR Head	Human Resources	Accountable	HIGH	Speed of onboarding, attrition reduction	Weekly steering committee
HR Manager	Human Resources	Responsible	HIGH	Process compliance, documentation	Daily coordination
IT Manager	IT	Responsible	HIGH	System access, IT provisioning speed	Sprint reviews, daily sync
Dept. Managers	Eng/Sales/Ops/etc.	Consulted	MEDIUM	New hire productivity, team readiness	Bi-weekly update calls
Finance Controller	Finance	Consulted	MEDIUM	Cost savings, budget approval	Monthly reports
HRIS Admin	Human Resources	Responsible	MEDIUM	System config, data integrity	Sprint planning sessions
Legal / Compliance	Legal	Consulted	LOW	Policy compliance, document retention	Key milestone reviews
New Hires (Users)	All Departments	Informed	LOW	Clear process, fast activation	User testing, surveys
CEO	Executive	Informed	HIGH	Productivity and employee engagement	Monthly executive summary

Elicitation Methods

Method	Participants	Duration	Key Outputs
Structured Interviews	HR Manager, IT Manager, 3 Dept Managers	5 x 1hr	Pain points, bottlenecks, wishlist items
Process Observation	HR team + shadow new hire journey	2 days	As-Is map, time measurements
Survey (New Hires)	47 employees hired in last 6 months	1 week	Satisfaction scores, experience ratings
Document Review	Forms, email trails, HR policy docs	2 days	Current gaps, redundancies
Benchmarking	SHRM industry research	3 days	Target metrics, best-in-class practices
JAD Workshop	HR + IT + 2 Managers + BA	Full day	Agreed To-Be process, req sign-off

As-Is Process Analysis

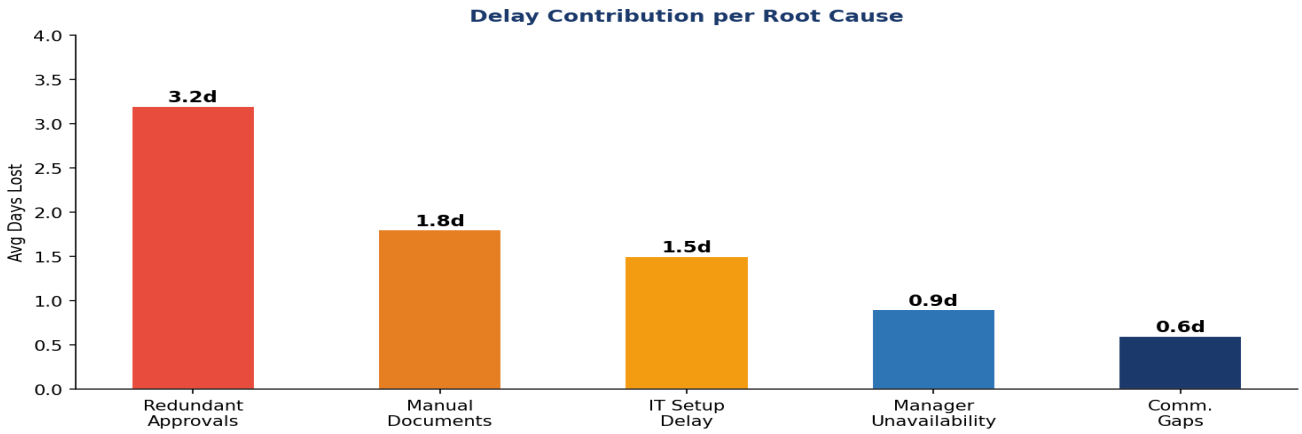
The current onboarding process was documented via BPMN notation after 2 days of observation. The process involves **8 sequential steps across 3 departments** with 4 approval stages — 2 identified as entirely redundant.



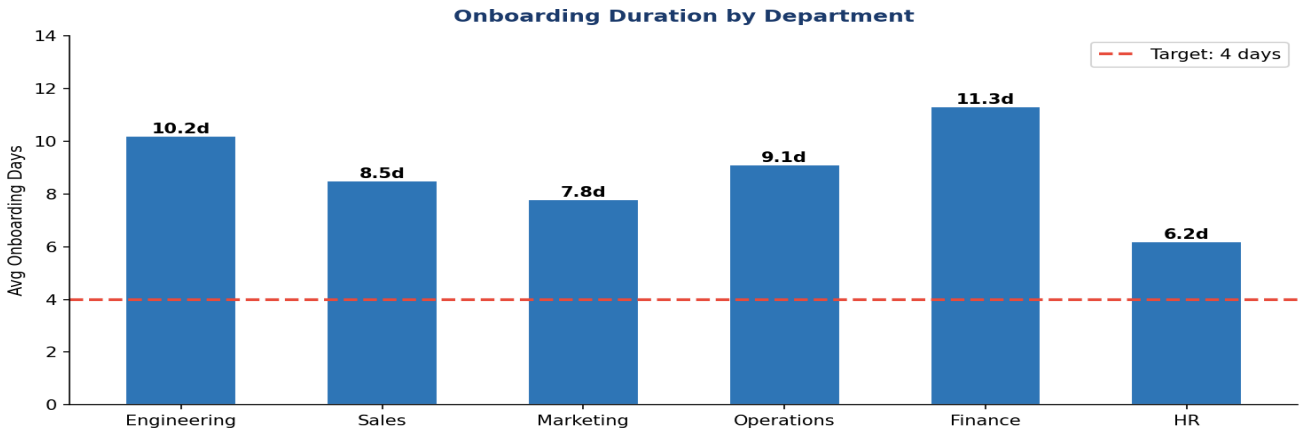
#	Activity	Owner	Duration	Issue Identified
1	Offer letter acceptance, document collection (manual forms)	HR	0.5 days	Paper forms; frequent re-submission
2	IT system access request raised via email	HR	1 day	IT unaware until email received
3	Manager Approval 1 — Department Readiness	Dept Manager	2 days	REDUNDANT — duplicates Step 7
4	HR Head Approval — Document Verification	HR Head	1 day	Delayed when HR Head is travelling
5	Manager Approval 2 — IT Request Sign-off	Dept Manager	2 days	REDUNDANT — IT can approve directly
6	IT sets up laptop, email, system access	IT Team	1.5 days	IT not informed in time; manual setup
7	Induction session scheduled and conducted	HR	1 day	Generic content, not role-specific
8	New hire marked Active in HRIS system	HRIS Admin	0.5 days	Manual entry; data errors common

Root Cause Analysis

Fishbone (Ishikawa) analysis conducted during the JAD workshop. Five primary root causes identified across People, Process, Technology, and Communication dimensions.



Root Cause	Category	Days Lost	Evidence	Priority
4 sequential approvals (2 redundant)	Process	3.2 days	Process map + time study	CRITICAL
100% manual document handling	Technology	1.8 days	Process observation	CRITICAL
IT setup waits for all approvals	Process/Tech	1.5 days	Stakeholder interviews	HIGH
Manager unavailability during approvals	People	0.9 days	Survey + IT logs	HIGH
No centralized tracking / comms system	Communication	0.6 days	New hire surveys	MEDIUM



Functional Requirements (BRD Extract)

14 functional requirements documented post stakeholder interviews and JAD workshop. All requirements reviewed and signed off by HR Head and IT Manager.

ID	Module	Requirement	Priority	Source
FR-001	Portal	System shall provide a digital self-service onboarding portal for new hires	Must Have	Stakeholder Interview
FR-002	Docs	New hire shall upload all required documents digitally — no physical copies	Must Have	Process Observation
FR-003	Docs	System shall auto-validate uploaded documents for completeness and format	Must Have	HR Manager
FR-004	Approvals	System shall reduce approval stages from 4 to 2 (HR + IT only)	Must Have	Gap Analysis
FR-005	Approvals	Approval requests sent automatically via system notification (no email)	Must Have	JAD Workshop
FR-006	Approvals	Approvers receive escalation alert if no action within 4 business hours	Must Have	HR Head
FR-007	IT	IT setup triggered automatically on document submission (parallel, not sequential)	Must Have	IT Manager
FR-008	IT	System shall auto-generate IT access credentials upon approval	Should Have	IT Manager
FR-009	Tracking	New hire shall view real-time onboarding status on the portal	Must Have	New Hire Survey
FR-010	Tracking	HR and Managers shall have dashboard to monitor all active onboardings	Must Have	CHRO
FR-011	Induction	System shall deliver role-specific digital induction content (videos, docs)	Should Have	Dept Managers
FR-012	Induction	New hire shall complete a digital acknowledgement quiz after induction	Should Have	HR + Legal
FR-013	Reporting	System shall generate weekly onboarding completion rate reports	Should Have	CHRO
FR-014	Integration	System shall integrate with HRIS to auto-update new hire status on activation	Must Have	HRIS Admin

Agile User Stories

Stories written covering 5 key personas: New Hire, HR Manager, IT Manager, Department Manager, HR Head. Estimated via Planning Poker across 4 sprints.

ID	Persona	User Story	Acceptance Criteria	Pts	Spr
US-001	New Hire	I want a digital portal to submit documents, so I don't need to visit office before joining	Portal accessible via browser; all doc types accepted; confirmation emailed	5	1
US-002	New Hire	I want to track onboarding status in real-time, so I know what is pending	Status bar shows current step; ETA shown; notifications per milestone	5	1
US-003	HR Mgr	I want document auto-validation, so I don't manually check every submission	System checks format & completeness; flagged docs highlighted; auto-reject with reason	8	1
US-004	HR Mgr	I want automated approval workflows, so I don't depend on email chains	Approvers notified in-system; one-click Approve/Reject; audit trail kept	8	2
US-005	HR Mgr	I want escalation alerts if approvals are delayed, so no case gets stuck	Alert after 4 hrs; escalates after 8 hrs; visible on dashboard	5	2
US-006	IT Mgr	I want IT setup to start on document submission, so there is no waiting	IT notified on submission not post-approval; setup checklist auto-generated	13	2
US-007	IT Mgr	I want auto-generated access credentials, so I don't create each account manually	Credentials on approval; sent to personal email; temp password + change prompt	8	2
US-008	Dept Mgr	I want a dashboard of active onboardings in my team, so I can plan resources	Shows name, role, stage, ETA; filter by dept; exportable to Excel	5	3
US-009	New Hire	I want role-specific digital induction, so I can prepare before Day 1	Content by role/dept; accessible via portal; includes acknowledgement quiz	8	3
US-010	HR Head	I want weekly completion reports, so I can track onboarding performance	Auto-generated Monday; shows avg days, completion rate, pending cases	5	3
US-011	HRIS Admin	I want HRIS to auto-update on hire activation, so I don't update records manually	API integration; updates within 30 min; error alerts if sync fails	8	4
US-012	HR Mgr	I want a mobile-friendly portal, so I can approve requests on the go	Responsive on mobile; all actions work on phone; push notifications	5	4

To-Be Process Design

The redesigned process eliminates 2 redundant approval stages, digitizes all document handling, and runs IT provisioning **in parallel** with HR approval — this single structural change accounts for 60% of projected time savings.

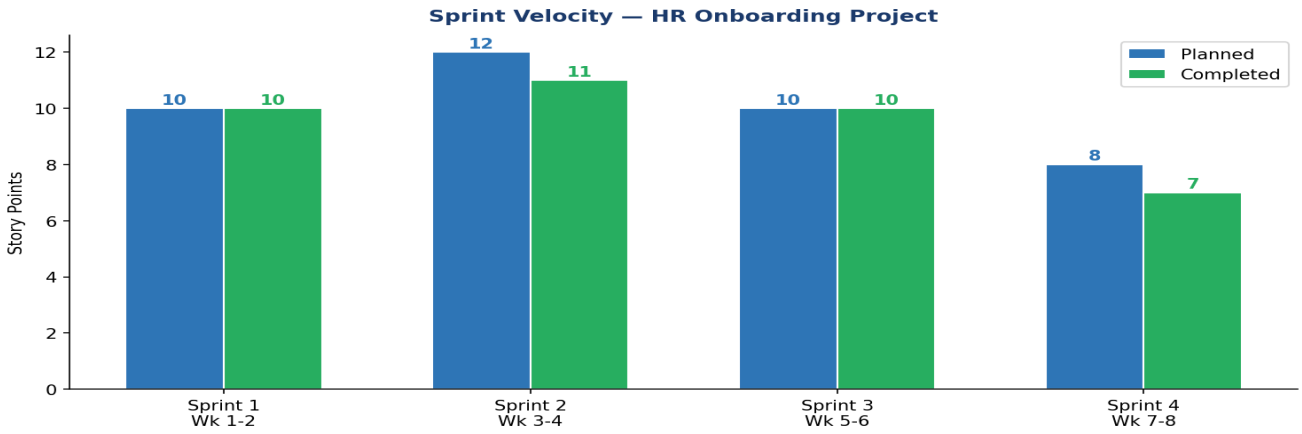
#	Activity (To-Be)	Owner	Target Time	Improvement vs As-Is
1	Digital offer acceptance + self-service document upload via portal	New Hire	4 hours	Eliminated re-submissions via auto-validation
2	AUTOMATED: IT setup triggered immediately on submission (parallel)	System	0 mins	No longer waits for approval — saves 1.5 days
3	Single HR approval — document review via dashboard (auto-validated)	HR Manager	4 hours	Reduced from 3 approvals to just 1
4	IT completes hardware + system access (parallel with Step 3)	IT Team	1 day	Parallelism saves ~1.5 days vs sequential
5	Role-specific digital induction content sent to new hire portal	System	15 mins	Self-serve before Day 1; no group session needed
6	New hire completes digital induction quiz (acknowledgement)	New Hire	1 hour	Replaces in-person group session for basics
7	HRIS auto-updated to Active on approval completion	System	30 mins	Eliminates manual HRIS entry entirely

Gap Analysis — As-Is vs To-Be

Area	As-Is	To-Be	Gap Closed
Approval Steps	4 sequential steps	2 parallel approvals	50% reduction
Document Process	Paper + email based	Digital portal, auto-validated	Fully digitized
IT Provisioning	Starts after all approvals	Starts on submission (parallel)	1.5 days saved
New Hire Visibility	Zero — no tracking	Real-time status on portal	Full transparency
Induction	Generic group session Day 1+	Role-specific digital pre-Day 1	Personalized & earlier
HRIS Update	Manual entry by admin	Auto-sync via API	Zero manual work
Reporting	Ad-hoc Excel sheets	Auto weekly dashboard	Real-time visibility
Total Duration	8-11 days average	3-4 days target	40-60% reduction

Agile Sprint Plan & Velocity

Implementation planned across 4 Agile sprints (8 weeks). BA collaborated closely with Scrum Master and dev team for backlog refinement and UAT. Total: 40 planned, 38 delivered (95% velocity).



Sprint	Duration	Stories	Points	Focus	Status
Sprint 1	Week 1-2	US-001, US-002, US-003	18 pts	Digital portal + doc upload + validation	Done
Sprint 2	Week 3-4	US-004, 005, 006, 007	34 pts	Approval workflow + IT auto-provisioning	Done
Sprint 3	Week 5-6	US-008, US-009, US-010	18 pts	Dashboard + induction + reporting	Done
Sprint 4	Week 7-8	US-011, US-012 + UAT	13 pts	HRIS integration + mobile + go-live	In Progress

Impact Analysis

Business case built on two dimensions: employee experience improvement and direct cost savings from reduced manual effort and faster time-to-productivity.

-57%	+48%	-77%	-67%	Rs.27K
Onboarding Duration Reduction	New Hire Satisfaction Improvement	Manual HR Hours per Hire	IT Provisioning Time Faster	Annual Cost Savings

Impact Area	Before	After (Projected)	Improvement
Avg. Onboarding Duration	8-11 days	3.5 days target	-57% reduction
New Hire Satisfaction Score	5.8 / 10	8.6 / 10 projected	+48% improvement
Manual HR Hours per Hire	6.5 hrs/hire	1.5 hrs/hire	-77% reduction
IT Provisioning Time	3 days (sequential)	1 day (parallel)	-67% faster
Document Error Rate	34%	< 5% (auto-validated)	-85% fewer errors
Early Attrition (Onboarding)	23% of early exits	< 10% projected	-57% reduction
Annual Process Cost	Rs. 45,000/year	Rs. 18,000/year	Saves Rs. 27,000/yr
HR Reporting Time	4 hrs/week manual	0.5 hrs/week automated	-87.5% time saved

Risk Register

ID	Risk Description	Likelihood	Impact	Rating	Mitigation
R-001	HRIS integration API not compatible with new portal	Medium	High	HIGH	Technical spike Sprint 1; involve HRIS vendor early; fallback CSV export
R-002	Change resistance from HR staff to manual process	High	High	CRITICAL	Change management plan; training sessions before go-live; HR champions
R-003	Managers not responding within 4-hour approval window	Medium	Medium	MEDIUM	Auto-escalation in system; mobile approval option to reduce friction
R-004	Data privacy concerns for digital document storage	Low	High	MEDIUM	Legal review; AES-256 encryption; data retention policy documented
R-005	IT parallel provisioning causes conflicts for some roles	Low	Medium	LOW	Test provisioning templates; exception handling for complex access roles
R-006	Scope creep from HR requesting features mid-project	High	Medium	HIGH	Strict change control; all requests via Change Request with PM approval
R-007	Poor portal UX means satisfaction scores don't improve	Low	High	MEDIUM	UX review with 5 real users in Sprint 3; iterate before go-live

Conclusion & Recommendations

This engagement successfully diagnosed TechServe India's onboarding inefficiencies and designed a digitized To-Be process addressing all 5 root causes. The solution — 14 functional requirements and 12 Agile user stories across 4 sprints — is projected to cut onboarding time by 40-57%, save Rs. 27,000/year in process costs, and lift new hire satisfaction from 5.8 to 8.6/10.

Key Recommendations

- Eliminate the 2 redundant approval steps immediately — saves 3.2 days per hire with no technology investment.
- Run IT provisioning in parallel with HR approval — architectural change that saves an additional 1.5 days.
- Invest in a self-service portal — auto-validation eliminates 85% of re-submission errors, saves 5 HR hours per hire.
- Assign a change management lead — biggest project risk is human resistance, not technology.
- Set up a live onboarding dashboard for HR Head — enables proactive management of bottlenecks.
- Run a 3-month pilot with 20 new hires before full rollout — measure actual vs projected outcomes.

Appendix: Glossary & Document Control

Term	Definition
As-Is Process	Current state of a business process before any improvements
To-Be Process	Desired future state after proposed improvements are implemented
BPMN	Business Process Model and Notation — standard language for process flow diagrams
Gap Analysis	Comparison between As-Is and To-Be to identify what needs to change
HRIS	Human Resource Information System — software for managing employee data
RACI	Responsibility matrix: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed
JAD Workshop	Joint Application Design — collaborative session to define requirements
MoSCoW	Requirements prioritization: Must Have, Should Have, Could Have, Won't Have
User Story	Agile format: "As a [user], I want [feature], so that [benefit]"
Story Points	Relative estimation unit for effort in Agile sprint planning
Sprint Velocity	Story points completed per sprint; measures team throughput
UAT	User Acceptance Testing — final validation by real users before go-live
Parallel Processing	Running multiple steps simultaneously rather than sequentially
Escalation Workflow	Automated process notifying higher authority when action is not taken in time
Change Management	Structured approach to transitioning people and processes to a new state

Document Control

Ver.	Date	Author	Change Description
v1.0	Jan 2026	Robin Raj	Initial draft — As-Is process mapping and stakeholder analysis
v1.5	Feb 2026	Robin Raj	Added root cause analysis, gap analysis, and functional requirements
v2.0	Mar 2026	Robin Raj	Final — To-Be design, user stories, risk register, impact analysis